

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Here's a tight, decision-ready cheat sheet you can use when classifying MNPS roles. It reflects our shared KSAC framework (Knowledge, Skills, Abilities, Competencies), MNPS role architecture, and how we've been separating scope, independence, and impact.

Technician vs Specialist vs Analyst

Dimension	Technician	Specialist	Analyst
Core Purpose	Execute defined tasks and operate tools/processes	Serve as subject-matter expert (SME) to solve domain-specific problems	Turn data/information into insights for decisions
Typical KSAC Emphasis	Procedural knowledge; tool proficiency; accuracy; safety	Deep domain knowledge; diagnostic & advisory skill; stakeholder guidance	Data literacy; statistics; modeling; synthesis; storytelling
Problem Type	Known/standard problems; repeatable steps	Varied, nuanced problems in a defined domain	Ambiguous/complex questions; trend/driver analysis
Independence	Works from SOPs/checklists with some discretion	Chooses methods within domain; recommends actions	Chooses questions/methods; frames decisions; quantifies trade-offs
Output	Completed work orders, processed items, maintained systems	Solutions, playbooks, training, domain recommendations	Dashboards, models, reports, scenarios, decision options
Decision Rights	Limited—within procedure	Advisory authority within domain	Advisory/decision-shaping via evidence; may set analytic standards
Examples (MNPS-ish)	Device imaging, badge printing, mail processing, data entry QA, lab setup	IEP scheduling SME, licensure SME, benefits SME, route optimization SME	Staffing model analysis, pay equity analysis, attendance risk model, program impact study

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Dimension	Technician	Specialist	Analyst
Title Test	“Can a precise SOP cover 80%+ of the work?” → Technician	“Is deep domain judgment the value?” → Specialist	“Are insights/metrics the product?” → Analyst

Common misclassifications

- “Tech Mail Center” with complex routing rules & training responsibilities may look “specialized,” but if 80% is SOP-driven processing → **Technician**.
- A “Data Specialist” who primarily cleans/imports data to specifications (no analysis/storytelling) → **Technician**; if they interpret trends and advise action → **Analyst**.
- “Program Specialist” doing family outreach scripts and roster updates → likely **Technician** unless they diagnose program issues and advise Principals → **Specialist**.

Coordinator vs Coach vs Manager

Dimension	Coordinator	Coach	Manager
Core Purpose	Orchestrate logistics, timelines, compliance steps, and stakeholder flow	Build others’ capability through modeling, feedback, and practice	Achieve outcomes through people, resources, and processes
Typical KSAC Emphasis	Organization; communication; workflow control; policy application	Instructional/functional expertise; adult learning; feedback; influence	Goal setting; prioritization; delegation; performance management; budgeting
Primary Output	Calendars, run-of-show, checklists, compliance packets, status boards	Improved practitioner performance; playbooks; PD sessions	Team results; service levels; KPIs; resource plans

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Dimension	Coordinator	Coach	Manager
Authority	Process authority; limited decision rights	Advisory/influence authority; may set practice standards	Direct people/resource authority; hires/evals; sets priorities
Examples (MNPS-ish)	Hiring event logistics, records/board packet routing, grant reporting calendars	Instructional coach, data use coach, HR systems adoption coach	HR operations manager, leave administration manager, transportation manager
Title Test	“Is the work primarily moving parts/people through defined steps?” → Coordinator	“Is the work improving others’ practice?” → Coach	“Is the work getting results through a team/budget?” → Manager

Edge checks

- A “Coordinator” who owns process design, metrics, and cross-team improvements (not just calendars) may be trending toward **Manager**.
- A “Coach” who also supervises staff/evaluations is likely **Manager** (or Coach + Manager split into two roles).

Minor Sub-Groupings: II vs III vs Lead

MNPS minor levels: 0 (unmarked), I, **II**, **III**, **Lead**. Use these when duties are materially different—not just tenure.

Level	Scope & Complexity	Independence & Judgment	Influence/Leadership	Typical Indicators
II	Broader task range within role; handles exceptions	Works with minimal supervision on routine + some non-routine	Trains peers informally; trusted go-to	Cross-site coverage, resolves escalations, maintains job aids

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Level	Scope & Complexity	Independence & Judgment	Influence/Leadership	Typical Indicators
III	Highest complexity in the role; designs improvements	Operates with wide latitude; sets methods/standards within role	Mentors widely; may lead initiatives	Owens complex caseloads, builds templates, drives process changes, quality owner
Lead	Coordinates work of others in same craft; point of contact	Prioritizes work; assigns tasks; reviews quality	Day-to-day direction without full supervisor HR authority	Schedules/assigns, first-level QA, escalates issues, onboards staff, runs standups

Leveling tests

- If the person **assigns/prioritizes** others' work and does first-line QA → **Lead**.
- If they **create standards/tools** and handle the hardest cases → **III**.
- If they are the **reliable escalations handler** and informal trainer → **II**.

Fast Decision Tree (use in intake)

1. **Is value created mainly by following defined procedures?**
→ **Technician** (then level: II = advanced execution; III = complex + improves methods; Lead = directs peers).
2. **Is value created mainly by deep subject-matter judgment and advising others in that domain?**
→ **Specialist** (then level as above).
3. **Is value created mainly by analyzing data to inform decisions?**
→ **Analyst** (then level as above; Lead Analyst may coordinate analysts' workload).
4. **Is the core of work logistics/compliance orchestration across stakeholders?**
→ **Coordinator**.
5. **Is the core of work improving others' practice through coaching cycles/PD?**
→ **Coach**.

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

6. **Is the core of work achieving outcomes through a team/budget with formal supervisory authority?**
→ **Manager.**
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Quick KSAC Mapping Cues

- **Technician:** Knowledge = systems/tools/SOPs; Skills = accuracy, throughput, troubleshooting; Abilities = follow procedures; Competencies = Ensures Accountability, Manages Ambiguity (at low level).
 - **Specialist:** Knowledge = deep domain (licensure, IEP, benefits, routing, FMLA); Skills = diagnosis, stakeholder advising; Abilities = problem framing; Competencies = Manages Complexity, Plans & Aligns, Interpersonal Savvy.
 - **Analyst:** Knowledge = data models, stats, visualization; Skills = SQL/Excel/BI, experimentation; Abilities = pattern finding, scenario building; Competencies = Decision Quality, Strategic Mindset, Communicates Insight.
 - **Coordinator:** Knowledge = policy & process maps; Skills = project coordination; Abilities = deadline control; Competencies = Plans & Aligns, Collaborates.
 - **Coach:** Knowledge = instructional/functional best practices; Skills = observation/feedback; Abilities = adult learning; Competencies = Develops Talent, Persuades.
 - **Manager:** Knowledge = operations & staffing; Skills = delegation, performance mgmt, budgeting; Abilities = prioritization; Competencies = Drives Results, Builds Effective Teams.
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Title Hygiene (MNPS style)

- **Technician:** “Mail Center Technician II” (no insight/SME claims).
- **Specialist:** “Licensure Specialist III” (domain in title).
- **Analyst:** “Compensation Analyst II” (analysis focus).
- **Coordinator:** “Recruitment Event Coordinator” (logistics/action).
- **Coach:** “Data Use Coach” / “Instructional Coach.”
- **Manager:** “Leave Administration Manager.”

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Pitfalls to Avoid

- Using “**Specialist**” when the work is mostly transactional (that’s **Technician**).
 - Calling someone “**Analyst**” when they don’t own analysis/storytelling (ETL only ≠ Analyst).
 - Labeling “**Coordinator**” when the person has people/budget authority (that’s **Manager**).
 - Granting **Lead** without true work direction/QA responsibility. Level by **scope**, not tenure.
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Interview/Intake Probes (copy/paste)

- “Describe a problem you solved last month. Did you follow a known SOP, apply domain judgment, or analyze data to recommend action?”
 - “What decisions can you make without approval?”
 - “Whose work do you direct or quality-check?”
 - “What standards, templates, or tools have you authored that others now use?”
 - “When priorities conflict, how do you choose what gets done first—and for whom?”
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Technician vs Skilled Laborer

Dimension	Technician	Skilled Laborer
Core Purpose	Execute system/equipment or data/process work using defined procedures and diagnostics.	Execute physical/trade work using hand/power tools and craft methods to build, move, repair, or maintain.
Primary Value	Reliability, accuracy, and uptime of devices, software, networks,	Safe, timely delivery of physical outputs: built/installed/assembled/moved/maintained spaces, grounds, materials.

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Dimension	Technician	Skilled Laborer
KSAC Emphasis	labs, A/V, ID/badging, data loads. Knowledge: SOPs, vendor specs, configs, basic networking/software. Skills: troubleshooting, calibration, data entry. Abilities: procedural thinking, documentation. Competencies: Ensures Accountability, Plans & Aligns.	Knowledge: materials, fasteners, tool use, jobsite safety. Skills: cutting, fastening, mixing, lifting, measuring. Abilities: stamina, spatial/mechanical sense. Competencies: Action Oriented, Safety Focus.
Problem Type	Known faults; device/app misconfig; data/process exceptions; A/V setups.	Physical tasks; routine repairs; site prep; event setup/tear-down; grounds/custodial projects.
Independence	Follows playbooks; chooses troubleshooting steps; may update job aids.	Follows work orders; selects tools/sequence for task; escalates for permits/advanced trades.
Tools/Equipment	Laptops, diagnostics, labelers/badge printers, MDM/console, multimeter, A/V switchers, small parts.	Hand/power tools, ladders, dollies, mowers/edgers, light carpentry/plumbing/paint gear, PPE.
Training/Certs	Vendor/device certs (e.g., Google Admin basics, JAMF, Crestron-style A/V), data hygiene.	OSHA/PPE, forklift, fall protection; may include trade helper/apprentice cards; CDL for logistics roles.

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Dimension	Technician	Skilled Laborer
Typical Output	Working device/account; imaged laptops; configured A/V; clean data import; printed badges.	Assembled furniture; hung whiteboards; event risers placed; mulch beds done; minor patch/paint; clutter cleared.
Decision Rights	Within SOP (escalate if outside scope); may recommend tool/process tweaks.	Within safety & work order; selects safe methods; escalate for licensed trade or structural work.
Physical Demand	Light–moderate; fine motor & screen time; occasional lifting.	Moderate–heavy; lifting, carrying, prolonged standing, outdoor exposure.
Title Test	“Is the value mainly diagnosing/configuring systems, devices, or data?” → Technician	“Is the value mainly building/moving/fixing the physical environment?” → Skilled Laborer

MNPS-Flavored Examples

- Badge Printer Setup + User Provisioning → Technician
 - Unload/assemble 40 classroom desks; mount boards; move cabinets → Skilled Laborer
 - Cart image 150 Chromebooks; inventory/MDM enroll → Technician
 - Stage gym for graduation, platforms/chairs/pipe-and-drape; teardown → Skilled Laborer
 - Set up auditorium A/V (switchers, mics, DSP presets) → Technician (A/V Tech)
 - Mulch, edging, debris removal, light fencing repair → Skilled Laborer
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Borderline & Misclassification Checks

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

- “Data Specialist” doing only uploads and renames per template → Technician, not Analyst.
 - “Warehouse Tech” that only lifts/moves/receives with scanners → usually Skilled Laborer (tech device is incidental).
 - Light fixture bulb swap & chair assembly → Skilled Laborer; panel wiring or device config → Technician.
 - If permits/licensure (electrical, plumbing) are routinely required, you’re moving into Skilled Trades (not generic Laborer/Technician).
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Leveling Cues (II / III / Lead within each track)

- **II:** Handles exceptions, cross-site coverage, trains peers informally.
- **III:** Tackles hardest cases; authors job aids/standards; improves methods.
- **Lead:** Assigns/prioritizes daily work; first-line QA; runs huddles—**no** full HR authority.

(Apply the same II/III/Lead logic inside either Technician or Skilled Laborer familie

Gating Rule (use first)

If the role performs **therapeutic or clinical interventions with students under a credentialed plan (IEP/BIP)** and **collects protected student data** under **clinical supervision** (e.g., BCBA), it is **not** Skilled Laborer. Classify within the **Technician/Specialist** family based on scope and independence.

Classification guidance

- **RBT / Behavior Tech** → typically Technician (Clinical/Behavior)
 - Level II/III based on complexity, fidelity, and ability to handle severe cases.
 - “Lead” if directing daily assignments/QA for other techs (no full HR authority).
- **Behavior Analyst / BCBA** → Analyst or Specialist (designs plans, analyzes data, advises teams).

Quick Decision Tree (RBT Check)

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

1. Does the role implement a BIP or therapeutic protocol under BCBA supervision? → Clinical/Behavior Tech (Technician)
 2. Is the primary output student behavioral progress + clinical documentation? → Clinical/Behavior Tech
 3. Is the primary output physical work product (furniture moves, grounds, setups)? → Skilled Laborer
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Clerk vs Administrative Assistant (MNPS Cheat Sheet)

Dimension	Clerk	Administrative Assistant
Core Purpose	Execute transactional records/process work accurately and on time.	Provide proactive administrative support to leaders/teams—prioritize, coordinate, and communicate.
Primary Value	Throughput, data integrity, compliance with SOPs.	Anticipation, prioritization, stakeholder coordination, executive/office enablement.
Typical KSAC Emphasis	Knowledge: forms, codes, data systems, filing rules. Skills: data entry, scanning, verification, queue management. Abilities: consistency, attention to detail. Competencies: Ensures Accountability, Manages Ambiguity (basic).	Knowledge: calendars, meeting protocols, procurement basics, district workflows. Skills: scheduling, correspondence, drafting briefs, vendor/staff coordination. Abilities: judgment, discretion, problem solving. Competencies: Plans & Aligns, Communicates Effectively, Situational Adaptability.
Problem Type	Routine/known (exceptions escalate): enrollments, attendance updates, invoice indexing, records requests.	Mixed/ambiguous: calendar conflicts, last-minute logistics, triaging requests, prepping leaders for meetings.
Independence & Judgment	Works from SOPs/checklists; limited discretion.	Chooses sequence & approach; acts as gatekeeper; drafts/revises communications.

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Dimension	Clerk	Administrative Assistant
Primary Outputs	Correct entries, reconciled batches, filed records, processed forms, updated queues.	Organized calendars/travel, agendas/minutes, briefings, polished emails/memos, coordinated events.
Decision Rights	Within procedure (accept/reject form, route per rule).	Prioritizes leader's time; commits to logistics; drafts responses within guidance.
Stakeholder Interaction	Transactional with staff/families; scripted responses.	High-touch with leaders, staff, vendors, and community; tailored messaging.
Tools	SIS/HRIS/finance modules, scanners, labelers, ticket queues.	Calendars (Outlook), Teams/Zoom, travel/procurement tools, templates, project trackers.
Confidentiality	Handles sensitive data under strict SOP.	Handles sensitive info + discretion/judgment in timing and messaging.
Title Test	"Is 80%+ of value accurate processing of records/forms per SOP?" → Clerk	"Is the value protecting/prioritizing a leader's time and coordinating work?" → Administrative Assistant

Quick Decision Tree

1. **Is the role primarily records/forms/data processing to standard?** → **Clerk**
 2. **Is the role primarily scheduling, correspondence, coordination, and leader enablement?** → **Administrative Assistant**
 3. **Blend?** If ≥70% transactional processing → Clerk; if ≥70% leader/office enablement → Administrative Assistant. Consider **two positions** if both are mission-critical.
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MNPS-Flavored Examples

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

- **Attendance data entry, student file assembly, immunization record indexing** → **Clerk** (School Office/Records Clerk).
 - **Principal's calendar management, agenda/minute prep, family escalations triage** → **Administrative Assistant** (to Principal).
 - **Voucher scanning & coding to accounts** → **Finance Clerk**.
 - **Board briefing prep, speaker confirmations, travel & reimbursements for a director** → **Administrative Assistant** (Department AA).
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Edge & Misclassification Checks

- If the role **drafts letters, briefs leaders, or gates access** → skews **Administrative Assistant**.
 - If the role **rarely writes original correspondence** and mostly **enters/verifies** → skews **Clerk**.
 - “Front desk” can be either: if mostly **sign-ins/calls** → **route** = Clerk; if also **complex scheduling, meeting prep, principal support** = Administrative Assistant.
 - If a “Clerk” is **designing office workflows, KPIs, and cross-team improvements**, consider **Administrative Assistant** or **Coordinator**.
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Leveling within Each Track (II / III / Lead)

- **II** – Advanced execution; handles exceptions; trains peers informally.
- **III** – Owns complex caseloads; authors job aids; improves methods and templates.
- **Lead** – Assigns/prioritizes daily desk coverage; first-line QA; runs huddles (no full HR authority).

(Apply levels inside the selected family: Clerk II/III/Lead vs Administrative Assistant II/III/Lead.)

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Instructor vs Teacher

Dimension	Instructor	Teacher
Core Purpose	Deliver defined content/training sessions to a target audience (often adults or non-credit student groups).	Lead a K-12 class as teacher of record : plan, instruct, assess, and ensure growth for all students.
Primary Value	Effective session delivery, skill transfer, and participant readiness for a specific task or module.	Standards-aligned learning, whole-child development, and measurable academic progress.
Audience	Adults (PD), staff, families, or students in short courses, labs, camps, or electives where credit/grades may be limited or absent.	Enrolled K-12 students in a scheduled course with grades/credits and yearlong accountability.
Curriculum Ownership	Uses prebuilt materials; adapts lightly for context; may create modules for workshops.	Designs/curates full units aligned to state standards; differentiates and scaffolds for diverse learners.
Assessment	Checks for understanding, skills demos, exit tickets, completion certificates.	Formal and informal assessments, grading/credit, progress monitoring, MTSS/RTI, data cycles.
Legal/Compliance	Minimal beyond basic safety and data privacy for participants.	IEP/504 fidelity, accommodations, supervision/duty of care, parent communication, grade/attendance rules.
Classroom Management	Manages session logistics and norms for a limited scope/time.	Full behavior management, routines, classroom culture, restorative practices over the term.

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Dimension	Instructor	Teacher
Stakeholder Scope	Coordinates with organizers; limited family outreach; no ongoing case management.	Frequent family communication; coordination with counselors, interventionists, related services.
KSAC Emphasis	Knowledge: subject/module content. Skills: facilitation, presentation, adult learning basics. Abilities: session pacing, resource setup. Competencies: Communicates Effectively, Plans & Aligns.	Knowledge: pedagogy, standards, assessment, special populations. Skills: differentiation, data-driven instruction, behavior systems. Abilities: relationship-building, perseverance. Competencies: Develops Talent (students), Ensures Accountability, Manages Complexity.
Decision Rights	Chooses methods within session; limited long-term accountability.	Chooses pedagogy, assessments, interventions; accountable for growth over time.
Title Test	“Is the job mainly delivering sessions/workshops/labs without being teacher of record?” → Instructor	“Is the job teacher of record with grading, standards, IEP compliance, and yearlong growth?” → Teacher

Fast Decision Tree

1. **Teacher of Record** (grades/credit, standards alignment, IEP/504, parent communication)? → **Teacher**
2. No teacher-of-record duties; primarily **facilitates trainings, labs, or short modules**? → **Instructor**
3. **Adult learning focus** (PD for staff)? → **Instructor** (or **Coach** if ongoing cycles to build teacher practice)

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

4. **Student enrichment club/camp** (short-term, no grades)? → **Instructor**
 5. **CTE/dual-enrollment**: If responsible for credit, safety compliance, and full course delivery as teacher of record → **Teacher** (CTE Teacher). If running skills labs under a teacher's plan → **Instructor / Technician** (context-dependent).
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MNPS-Flavored Examples

- **New-hire timekeeping workshop leader** → **Instructor** (HR PD Instructor).
 - **After-school robotics camp leader (no credit)** → **Instructor**.
 - **Algebra I course lead** with grades, IEP accommodations, parent updates → **Teacher**.
 - **CTE Welding** with credit, safety plans, industry standards → **Teacher (CTE)**.
 - **Family engagement mini-course on FAFSA** → **Instructor**.
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Edge & Misclassification Checks

- **Coach vs Instructor**: If the role's purpose is **improving educators' practice via observation/feedback cycles**, that's **Coach**, not Instructor.
 - **Paraprofessional running small groups** under a teacher's plan is **not** Instructor or Teacher—classifies as **Classroom Support/Technician**.
 - **Substitute Teacher** (coverage without planning/assessment accountability) ≠ Teacher of record—classify as **Substitute** track, not Teacher.
 - **Teaching Artist** leading short residencies without grading → **Instructor**; if they own a graded course → **Teacher**.
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Leveling within Each Track (Lead)

(Apply within the chosen family; not to move between families)

- **Lead** – Coordinates peers' schedules, assigns coverage, runs huddles, and performs first-line QA (no full HR authority).

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Assistant vs Coordinator

Dimension	Assistant	Coordinator
Core Purpose	Provide direct support to a person/office (calendar, correspondence, logistics, documents).	Orchestrate a process or program across people, steps, and timelines to completion.
Primary Value	Protecting leaders' time; smooth office operations; polished communications.	On-time, compliant delivery of multi-step work; cross-team alignment; visible status.
Scope of Work	Task/meeting support around one leader or unit; work is person-centered.	End-to-end workflow ownership (events, grant/report cycles, hiring pipeline, records projects).
Independence & Judgment	Chooses sequencing for support tasks; follows leader preferences.	Chooses methods/tools to keep the process moving; manages dependencies/escalations.
Outputs	Agendas/minutes, travel & purchase requests, drafted emails/memos, meeting packs.	Run-of-show plans, trackers/dashboards, stakeholder comms, checklists, packets, submissions.
Decision Rights	Gatekeeping calendars; minor commitments per guidance.	Sets timelines, assigns action items, chases deliverables; accepts/returns items for quality.
Stakeholder Interaction	Frequent 1:1s; vendor/staff touchpoints on behalf of leader; customer service.	Broad cross-functional coordination with principals, vendors, HR/Finance/IT, community partners.
Complexity	Reactive/short-horizon problems; rapid reprioritization.	Multi-party, deadline-driven problems; compliance and critical path management.
KSAC Emphasis	Knowledge: office systems, protocols. Skills: scheduling, correspondence,	Knowledge: policy/process maps, SLAs, forms. Skills: project coordination, tracking, risk/issue mgmt. Abilities:

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Dimension	Assistant	Coordinator
	proofreading. Abilities: discretion, service. Competencies: Communicates Effectively, Plans & Aligns.	systems thinking, follow-through. Competencies: Ensures Accountability, Drives Results, Collaborates.
Title Test	“Is the value mainly enabling a person/office?” → Assistant	“Is the value mainly delivering a process/program?” → Coordinator

Fast Decision Tree

1. **Is the role centered on enabling a specific leader/office (calendars, correspondence, meeting prep)?** → **Assistant**
 2. **Is the role centered on moving work through defined steps with many parties and deadlines?** → **Coordinator**
 3. Blend? If $\geq 70\%$ process ownership with trackers/deadlines/compliance → **Coordinator**. If $\geq 70\%$ leader enablement and office operations → **Assistant**. Consider two positions if both are mission-critical.
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MNPS-Flavored Examples

- **Assistant:** Administrative Assistant to Principal/Director; manages calendars, correspondence, travel, board packet prep for that leader.
 - **Coordinator:** Recruitment Event Coordinator (venues, vendors, comms, sign-ups, run-of-show); Records Coordinator (public records queue, redactions, releases); Benefits Enrollment Coordinator (windows, notices, audits).
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Edge & Misclassification Checks

- If the role **designs the workflow, owns the tracker, defines checkpoints, and drives others to closure**, that's **Coordinator**, not Assistant.
- If the role **drafts sensitive comms, gates access to the leader, and balances that person's priorities**, that's **Assistant**, not Coordinator.

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

- A “Front Desk” role doing sign-ins/calls/routing is **Assistant/Clerk**; if it also owns **event cycles** or **compliance packets** across teams, it’s trending **Coordinator**.
 - If someone supervises staff/budget with performance management, that’s **Manager**, not Coordinator.
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Leveling Within Each Family (II / III / Lead)

- **Assistant II** – Advanced support for complex calendars; prepares meeting packets; handles routine issues independently.
 - **Assistant III** – Anticipates needs; drafts briefs; builds templates; mentors other assistants.
 - **Assistant Lead** – Schedules coverage, assigns front-desk duties, first-line QA (no full HR authority).
 - **Coordinator II** – Runs established processes; maintains trackers; resolves standard risks.
 - **Coordinator III** – Improves processes/metrics; authors SOPs/kits; leads cross-team improvements.
 - **Coordinator Lead** – Coordinates workloads of other coordinators; sets cadence/stand-ups; QA on deliverables (no full HR authority).
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Representative vs Facilitator vs Coordinator vs Liaison

Dimension	Representative	Facilitator	Coordinator	Liaison
Core Purpose	Case-level service, intake, resolution, and advocacy	Structure dialogue so groups learn/decide	Deliver program/process on time & in-scope	Build/maintain cross-org relationships & alignment
Knowledge	School facilities & resources; student support; parent engagement;	Facilitation techniques; group dynamics; meeting mgmt; DEI	Project mgmt; team coordination; budgets/resource	Relationship building; cross-cultural comms; networking; diplomacy

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Dimension	Representative	Facilitator	Coordinator	Liaison
	cultural sensitivity		s; strategic planning	
Skills	Active listening; negotiation; presentation; problem-solving; networking	Communication; conflict resolution; active listening; collaboration	Organizational skills; comms; problem-solving; negotiation	Communication; problem-solving; active listening; time mgmt; decision-making
Abilities	Adaptability; relationship building; time mgmt; resilience	Adaptability; emotional intelligence; time mgmt; empathy	Time mgmt; adaptability; interpersonal skills; critical thinking	Empathy; cultural awareness; resilience; flexibility
Competencies	Communicates Effectively; Manages Complexity; Collaborates; Persuades; Cultural Intelligence	Drives Vision & Purpose; Resourcefulness; Action Oriented; Develops Talent; Collaborates; Decision Quality; Cultural Intelligence; Communicates Effectively	Drives Vision & Purpose; Resourcefulness; Action Oriented; Develops Talent; Collaborates; Decision Quality; Manages Conflict; Self-Awareness	Situational Adaptability; Collaborates; Manages Ambiguity; Self-Awareness; Communicates Effectively
Primary Output	Closed tickets/cases, accurate info, documented guidance	Agendas, norms, consensus, PD artifacts, action items	Trackers, run-of-show, packets, submissions, dashboards	MOUs/agreements, partner calendars, issue logs, stakeholder alignment notes
Decision Rights	Routine approvals within	Decide process for discussion/learni	Set cadence, gates, and acceptance	Broker agreements; set expectations

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

Dimension	Representative	Facilitator	Coordinator	Liaison
	policy; escalate non-routine	ng; content-neutral	criteria; return low-quality items	across parties; escalate barriers
Who they serve	Families, employees, students, vendors (front-line)	Staff teams, leaders, community groups (in the room)	Cross-functional internal teams + vendors	External partners + internal leads (across org boundaries)

Quick Definitions (use these first)

- **Representative** → Front-line **service & advocacy** for a program/office; resolves cases and explains options to families/staff.
 - **Facilitator** → **Guides groups** to decisions/learning; neutral process owner for meetings, PD, or consensus work.
 - **Coordinator** → **Runs the process/program** end-to-end (timelines, checkpoints, deliverables, compliance).
 - **Liaison** → **Bridges organizations/communities**; maintains relationships, aligns expectations, and clears barriers.
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Fast Decision Tree (copy/paste)

1. **Is success measured by case resolution & customer experience?** → **Representative**
2. **Is success measured by a group's ability to decide/learn together (neutral process owner)?** → **Facilitator**
3. **Is success delivering a multi-step program/process on time with compliance?** → **Coordinator**
4. **Is success sustained alignment between MNPS and external stakeholders (bridging boundaries)?** → **Liaison**

If mixed:

- ≥70% cases/interactions → Representative

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

- ≥70% meeting/learning/process **in-the-room** work → Facilitator
 - ≥70% timeline/trackers/deliverables → Coordinator
 - ≥70% external partner alignment → Liaison
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Edge & Misclassification Checks

- **Rep vs Coord:** If they **own the master tracker and acceptance gates**, that's **Coordinator**, not Representative—even if they answer phones.
 - **Fac vs Coord:** Facilitator **guides the conversation**; Coordinator **owns the project plan**. If the same person does both, split duties or title “Coordinator & Facilitator.”
 - **Liaison vs Rep:** Representative resolves **individual cases**; Liaison sustains **institutional relationships** and solves cross-org issues.
 - **Liaison vs Coordinator:** If most time is **external alignment & diplomacy** (MOUs, community partners) → Liaison. If it's **internal timelines & packets** → Coordinator.
 - **Facilitator neutrality:** If the person is **pushing a predetermined solution**, they're not acting as a Facilitator; they may be a Coordinator or Representative delivering a message.
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MNPS-Flavored Examples

- **Representative:** Benefits Rep answering eligibility, logging tickets, closing routine enrollments; Records Rep explaining request steps & timelines.
 - **Facilitator:** PD session leader using protocols; boundary spanner running IEP or cross-team retros using norms/action logs (content-neutral).
 - **Coordinator:** Recruitment Event Coordinator (venues, vendors, comms, run-of-show); Public Records Coordinator (deadlines, redaction packet flow).
 - **Liaison:** Community Liaison connecting schools with nonprofits; Higher-Ed Liaison aligning dual-enrollment processes; Family Liaison bridging cultural/linguistic gaps across schools.
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Intake Prompts (to classify quickly)

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

- “What are your **primary artifacts**?” (CRM notes/scripts → Rep; agendas/norms → Fac; trackers/packets → Coord; MOUs/partner logs → Liaison)
 - “Who depends on you **day to day**?” (Customers → Rep; groups in meetings → Fac; cross-functional teams → Coord; external partners + internal leaders → Liaison)
 - “What decisions do you make **without approval**?” (Case outcomes within policy → Rep; meeting process/timeboxes → Fac; timeline gates/acceptance criteria → Coord; partner expectations/escalation path → Liaison)
 - “Describe your last **escalation**.” (Customer case → Rep; meeting conflict → Fac; deadline risk → Coord; partner misalignment → Liaison)
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Leveling within Each Family (II / III / Lead)

(Use when duties are materially different—not tenure.)

- **Representative**
 - **II**: Handles escalations; cross-trained queues; drafts macros.
 - **III**: Resolves complex cases; updates policy FAQs; mentors reps.
 - **Lead**: Assigns queue; first-line QA; runs huddles (no full HR authority).
- **Facilitator**
 - **II**: Runs standard protocols; manages simple consensus.
 - **III**: Designs/adapts protocols; handles high-conflict sessions; trains facilitators.
 - **Lead**: Assigns sessions; QA on facilitation artifacts; sets facilitation standards.
- **Coordinator**
 - **II**: Operates established workflows; maintains trackers; resolves standard risks.
 - **III**: Redesigns process/SOPs; sets metrics; leads cross-team improvements.
 - **Lead**: Balances workloads; sets cadence; accepts/returns deliverables for quality.
- **Liaison**

Problem Role Cheat Sheet

- **II:** Manages partner roster & regular touchpoints; resolves routine issues.
- **III:** Brokers complex agreements; navigates cultural/linguistic barriers; advises leaders.
- **Lead:** Orchestrates multi-partner portfolios; coaches liaisons; owns escalation paths.